

Australian dwelling prices: capital cities diverge further

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March Cotality home value index: +0.6%*mt*h; +9.3%*yr*



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The Cotality home value index rose 0.6%*in* March, following gains of 0.5%*mt*h in February, 0.6%*mt*h in January and 0.4%*mt*h in December. Annual growth was broadly steady at 9.3%*yr*.

The March update confirms that the changed interest rate outlook has translated into moderation in price growth and a sharper pull-back in turnover.

The slowdown remains concentrated in Sydney and Melbourne, where prices declined modestly in March and turnover has softened materially. In contrast, price growth continues to track a strong pace across the mid-sized capitals of Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth.

With further interest rate increases expected over coming months, additional headwinds are likely, and the scope for renewed acceleration in price growth appears increasingly limited.

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